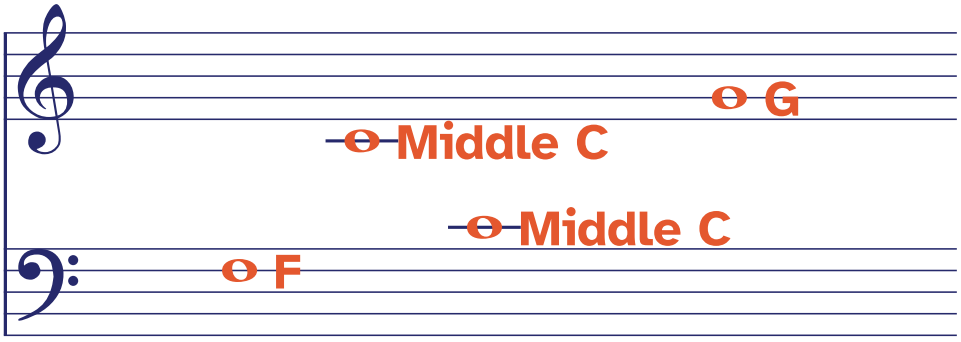
PART I · PITCH · 3

Reading the notes

Every line and space has one letter. You do not have to learn them all at once: start from a note you always know, then **step** or **skip** to the one you want.

THE SECRET

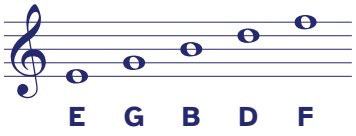
Start from a note you know (bass F, Middle C, treble G), then step or skip.



Notes you always know: treble G, bass F, and Middle C in either clef

THE RULE

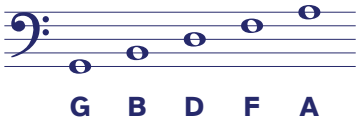
Step: to the very next line or space (one letter on). Skip: line to the next line, or space to the next space (two letters on).



Treble lines, E G B D F: *Every Good Boy Deserves Fun*



Treble spaces, F A C E: they spell *FACE*



Bass lines, G B D F A: *Great Big Dragons Fly Away*

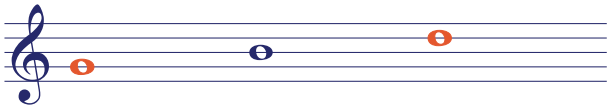


Bass spaces, A C E G: *All Cows Eat Grass*

PART I · PITCH · 3 · CONTINUED

EXAMPLE 1

Read a note you are not sure of

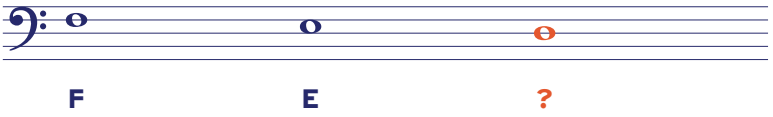


1. **The clef:** treble, so the clef note is G, on line 2.
2. **From G, skip up** line to line: one letter jumped each time.
3. **Count the skips** up to the other red note, on line 4: G, then B, then …

The red note is **D**: G, B, D, two skips up from the clef's G.

EXAMPLE 2

Read a bass note from the clef

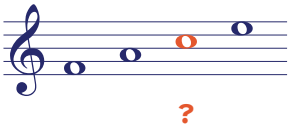


1. **The bass clef's dots** sit either side of line 4: that line is F.
2. **Step down** to the space below.
3. **One more step down** to the red note on line 3.

F, E, **D**: bass line 3 is D, two steps down from the clef's F.

EXAMPLE 3

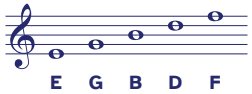
Find Treble C on the staff



1. **These notes sit in the spaces.** The bottom space is F.
2. **Step up through the spaces:** F, A … they spell a word.
3. **The red note is space 3.** Which letter is it?

F A **C** E: space 3 is **C**, Treble C, the same C you found on the keyboard, one octave above Middle C.

TRY IT · 10 SECONDS



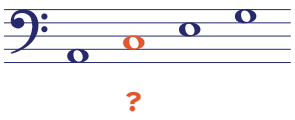
Say the treble lines up and down.

"E G B D F", then "F D B G E", out loud, as fast as you can without a slip. Then the spaces: "F A C E".

PART I · PITCH · 3 · CONTINUED

EXAMPLE 4

Find Bass C on the staff



1. **These notes sit in the bass spaces.** The bottom space is A: *All.*
2. **Say the next word:** *All Cows …*
3. **The red note is space 2.** Which letter?

A **C** E G: space 2 of the bass staff is **C**, Bass C, one octave below Middle C.

GAME

Name it from the clef note

1 treble line 3

2 treble space 1

3 bass line 3
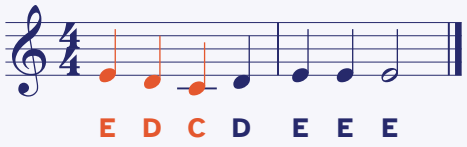
4 bass space 3

Start from the clef note (treble G on line 2, bass F on line 4), then step or skip.

Answer: 1 B (skip up from G) · 2 F (step down from G) · 3 D (two steps down from F) · 4 E (step down from F).

YOU KNOW THIS

Mary Had a Little Lamb



E D C: **line, space, ledger line**, one step down each time. Read the shape and the tune walks down with it.

Try it. Read the notes aloud before you play them.

THINK OF IT The clef notes are lamp posts on a dark road: walk from the nearest one and you are never lost.

TRAP

- × Naming bass notes with treble names: in the bass, the bottom line is G, not E.
- × Mixing up step and skip: a step changes line to space; a skip stays on lines (or on spaces).

SEE ALSO

The staff and the clefs p. 27 · The staff and the keyboard p. 33

PRACTISE IT

Workbook Pitch 3 · Online: Line and Space Names · Steps & Skips